

TAB 18



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-011-24/25, Version: 1

Ms. Ortiz Franklin - Safe, Sustainable Streets: Walk & Roll to School (Res-011-24/25) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to student safety on and around campuses and the District's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan affirms the District's commitment to welcoming learning environments, which includes ensuring "safe passage" to and from school through coordination with local civic and safety organizations;

Whereas, The District is a leader in climate sustainability and is taking proactive steps and demonstrating progress to becoming the most sustainable and environmentally-friendly large urban school district in the country;

Whereas, Over the last three school years, students across all school levels report in the School Experience survey that they feel less safe in the neighborhood around their school than they did in previous years, with only 58.5% of elementary students, 55.2% of middle school students, and 51.6% of high school students reporting they feel safe in their community in the 2023-2024 school year;

Whereas, There were 336 traffic fatalities in Los Angeles City in 2023, an 8% increase from the previous year, 178 of which resulted in pedestrian death
<<https://www.streetsareforeveryone.org/blog/traffic-violence-in-la-for-2023>>, and the leading cause of death for children between the ages of 4 and 14 in Los Angeles County is traffic collisions with disproportionate inequities in communities where Black and Brown families live;

Whereas, The City of Los Angeles has taken important steps to enhance traffic safety around Los Angeles Unified schools, including funding more than 500 crossing guards for the 2024-2025 school year, implementing "quick build" street safety projects at over 180 intersections at more than 40 schools, installing over 250 speed humps near 92 schools where speeding is a known issue, and establishing "school slow zones" with 15 mph speed limits on more than 450 street segments around 190 schools; and the District collaborates with the City's Safe Routes to School program, which maps recommended crossings to schools;

Whereas, Walking to school provides positive opportunities for students to meet their daily physical activity levels, cultivates a sense of responsibility and independence, contributes to time spent outdoors, which promotes positive health and can improve academic performance;

Whereas, The National Center for Safe Routes to School hosts an annual Walk & Roll to School Day, which will take place on October 9, 2024, an annual event that involves communities from across the country walking and rolling to school on the same day, which informs students and caregivers about pedestrian safety practices, fosters a sense of community, shines light on the need for safe routes to and from school and contributes to cleaner environments; and

Whereas, One time events such as Walk & Roll to School Day can increase the visibility of families active travel to schools for drivers who share the roads; lead to the development of regular walking and bicycling programs by encouraging more families to use active travel to get to school; and strengthen the partnership between the District, cities, and caregivers to ensure student safety; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will celebrate annually the Walk & Roll to School Day beginning on October 9, 2024 and in future years will continue to celebrate this day as established by the National Center for Safe Routes to School;

Resolved further, That to support successful implementation of Walk & Roll to School Day, in collaboration with on-going efforts, community partners, and local government agencies, the District will conduct an assessment of the safety and capability to safely walk and roll to school; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the District will continue to advocate for local, state and federal funding and legislation to support safer, walkable school communities.